

STEVE WALKER MSc, BSc

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Experienced **Software** Engineer and former CTO with 24+ years of success in leading product development, architecting innovative solutions, and driving technological advancements. Expertise in **cross**-platform design, e-commerce, **security**, integrations, and **data modeling**. Proven **leadership** in managing teams and projects across various sectors, including entertainment, fintech, and healthcare.

SUMMARY OF QUALIFICATIONS

- Emmy Award Winner: Associate Producer NBCOlympics.com 2014
- More than 24 years of experience as a CTO and Full Stack **Developer**, with specific focus on enterprise technologies and web-based solutions in PHP, Node.js, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CEO / Architect

Essentra **Software** LLC (Consulting)

Sep 2017 – Present
San Antonio, Texas

- Consulted on various projects in the entertainment, fintech, medical, insurance and **education** sectors with technologies such as Node.js, React, Angular, Laravel, Vue.js, Angular, React. Some projects include:
- **Marvel.com and Disney (Drupal 8, React, Laravel)**
Architected full **API integration** between Marvel and Disney (Technologies: Node.js, PHP, Laravel, Vue.js, MySQL, Docker, AWS, Pub/Sub). Implemented **security** remediations for issues discovered while running Pen Tests on marvel.com. Optimized performance of Node.js / Drupal 7 stack powering marvel.com and associated apps. Architected and built an **integration** with iTunes and other business partners responsible for **continuous** synchronization of availability, pricing, and sales **data** for a rapidly expanding collection of 35k+ 'in-app purchase' products (Node.js, GraphQL, Laravel, Linux)
- **Jewelers Mutual (Drupal 8)**
Directed a development **team** supporting jewelersmutual.com, enhancing performance and integrating with key partners like Geico, **Salesforce** and Hubspot
- **Teachersfcu.org (Drupal 8)**
Provided **system security**, deployment process, module and theme upgrades. Planned a path for Drupal 9 Upgrade
- **WheelOfFortune.com (Drupal 8)**
Architected their website redesign built in Drupal 8, React. Implemented integrations with Gigya and Solr Search and other platforms
- **Savers.com (Contentful, React)**
Implemented headless design. Implemented integrations with Solr Search
- **Nvent.com (Drupal 8, 7)**
Migrated global product catalog for Nvent.com to Drupal 8, optimizing internationalization and deployment pipelines.
- **LifetimeVintage.com (Shopify, Laravel)**
Architected and developed Shopify/Laravel/Vue.js solution for lifetimevintage.com (Shopify, Laravel)
- **WildKingdom.com (Laravel, Youtube, API)**
Architected and developed Laravel website with Youtube player **integration** solution for Mutual Of Omaha in order to revamp their Wild Kingdom brand and educational website

Director of Drupal Development
IPC International, Inc.

Jun 2022 – Oct 2024
Chicago, IL

- **Strategic Leadership:** Defined and executed the Drupal development strategy aligned with organizational goals, ensuring scalability and adaptability to evolving business needs.
- **Budgeting & Forecasting:** Managed the annual budget for the Drupal development department, including forecasting resource needs, cost estimation, and optimizing expenditures to align with financial objectives.
- **Team Oversight:** Directed a multidisciplinary team of engineers and business professionals, fostering talent development, mentorship, and succession planning. Conducted performance evaluations, identified skill gaps, and implemented training programs.
- **Stakeholder Engagement:** Delivered presentations to the executive board, providing insights on project status, resource utilization, and technical roadmaps. Effectively communicated complex technical concepts to non-technical stakeholders.
- **Agile Governance:** Established and refined Agile processes, ensuring efficient resource allocation, streamlined workflows, and adherence to delivery timelines across multiple concurrent projects.
- **Cross-Department Collaboration:** Partnered with business units, marketing, and IT to define project requirements, prioritize initiatives, and align technical solutions with organizational objectives.
- **Innovation & Strategy:** Identified emerging trends in Drupal and related technologies, integrating innovations to maintain competitive advantage. Contributed to long-term planning for digital transformation and platform evolution.

Key Achievements:

- Optimized the Drupal development budget, reducing operational costs while enabling consistent and reliable software delivery.
- Enhanced organizational decision-making by delivering data-driven board presentations that aligned technical roadmaps with business priorities.
- Successfully migrated critical systems to Drupal 10, ensuring seamless operation and improved performance for global users.
- Strengthened team efficiency by implementing advanced Agile frameworks and fostering a collaborative, high-performance culture.

Senior Manager, Software Engineering
IPC International, Inc.

Dec 2020 – Jun 2022
Chicago, IL

- **Technical Leadership:** Led a team of software engineers in the design, development, and maintenance of multiple enterprise e-commerce platforms, serving international and domestic clients using Agile methodologies, including Scrum, TDD, and XP practices.
- **Drupal Expertise:** Led the migration of multiple production environments from Drupal 8 to Drupal 10, managing extensive custom modules and code. Ensured scalability, security, and performance optimization across the platform.
- **Architectural Oversight:** Functioned as the lead architect, designing and implementing solutions for e-commerce, LMS, and CMS systems. Architected integrations between Drupal, Moodle, NetSuite, .NET, AWS. Maintained coding standards, designed and implemented CI/CD deployment pipelines, Test Drive Development (TDD), automated testing, and ensured reusable and maintainable codebases.
- **Team Management:** Conducted performance reviews, mentoring, and coaching for team members. Oversaw resource planning, project timelines, and cross-functional communication with stakeholders and executives.
- **Agile Implementation:** Spearheaded Agile ceremonies, including story writing, sprint planning, and retrospectives. Partnered with business leaders to define user stories and prioritize technical debt reduction.
- **Maintenance and Troubleshooting:** Diagnosed and resolved complex performance bottlenecks in MySQL databases, web servers and REST APIs. Delivered root-cause analysis for production defects and implemented robust fixes.
- **Technology Exploration:** Researched and adopted modern software development tools and practices to enhance team productivity and application performance.

Technologies & Tools: PHP, Drupal, MySQL, JavaScript, CSS3/HTML5, Git/GitLab, Jira, automated testing frameworks, Jenkins/Chronicle.

Key Achievements:

- Led the migration of legacy systems, resulting in a 37% **improvement** in performance and a 30% increase in user engagement.
- Strengthened **team** efficiency by fostering a culture of **collaboration**, innovation, and adherence to Agile principles.
- Delivered projects on time and within budget while maintaining high-**quality** standards.

Senior Drupal Developer

NBC Sports Group

Nov 2012 – Jan 2020

Stamford, CT

- Fortune 100 International media and entertainment company which provides sports and news **programming** across several international markets.
- Received an Emmy Award for Associate Producer of nbcolympics.com (Drupal 8/7/6/5, Word Press)
- Developed several custom modules and integrations to **support** the NBC group of sites (Drupal 7, **API's** Vue.js)
- Architected integrations between Yahoo, MSN, Google, and several other NBC partners supporting the nbcsports.com platform
- Developed Dev-ops **software** responsible for CI/CD and automated development (Docker, Linux, AWS)
- Migrated site from Drupal 7 to Drupal 8

CTO

Travel Keys

Aug 2009 – Aug 2016

Atlanta, GA

- Architect: designed developing and managing 300+ websites in the high performance, Travel Keys network
- Lead a **team** of developers who built and maintained the network of LAMP based travel sites
- Created **API** Integrations for partners including Homeaway, Flipkey, **Salesforce**

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

MSc. E-Commerce Technology (Distinction)

UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX, COLCHESTER UK CO4 3SQ, FACULTY OF **COMPUTER SCIENCE**

2006

BSc. Computer Science & Management (Hons)

UNIVERSITY OF THE WEST INDIES, BARBADOS WI, FACULTY OF **COMPUTER SCIENCE**

2001

TECHNICAL SKILLS, PLATFORMS AND TOOLS

- **Web Development:** LAMP, Drupal, Laravel, Lumen, WordPress, Ruby on Rails (RoR), CakePHP, Symfony, CodeIgniter, JavaScript, JQuery, Node.js, Vue.js, Next.js, React, Angular, Express, CSS, SASS, Less, Tailwind
- **Mobile Development:** Express, Flutter
- **Software Engineering:** Python, Object-Oriented **Programming**, UML, Design Patterns, MVC, Java, C#, C, C++, .NET, PHP, Unit Testing, Git, Subversion, Multi-threaded environments
- **Distributed Computing:** Amazon AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda), Apache Hadoop, GCP
- **Customer Relationship Management (CRM):** **Salesforce**, **Apex**, SugarCRM, NetSuite
- **Database Management:** MySQL, NoSQL, DB2, Oracle, SQL Server, PostgreSQL, MongoDB
- **Project Management:** Jira, Confluence, MS Project, Workfront
- **Web Services & APIs:** **SOAP**, REST, XML, Schema, DTD, Swagger, GraphQL, Shopify, iTunes
- **DevOps & CI/CD:** Azure, AWS, GCP, Docker, Vagrant, Lando, Apache, Nginx, Jenkins, Chronicle, Memcached, Redis, Windows, macOS, Linux, GitLab, Bitbucket, Travis CI, Heroku

Steve Walker

- Fayetteville, GA, US

Contact Information

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- 2103874465

Work History

Total Work Experience: 14 years

- **Director Of Drupal Development IPC International, Inc.**
Jun 01, 2022
- **Solutions Architect Essentra Software**
Jan 01, 2021
- **Senior Manager, Software Engineering Ipc International, Inc.**
Dec 01, 2020
- **Senior Full Stack Developer NBC Sports Group**
Sep 01, 2012
- **Senior Developer Active Objects LLC**
Dec 01, 2011

Education

- **Masters** | University of Essex
- **Bachelors** | University of West Indies

Skills

- **software development** - 24 years
- **html** - 20 years
- **consulting** - 15 years
- **electronic commerce** - 15 years
- **cloud** - 11 years
- **git** - 10 years
- **it project management** - 10 years
- **project management** - 10 years
- **restful** - 10 years
- **agile** - 8 years
- **devops** - 8 years
- **sass** - 8 years
- **microsoft sql server** - 6 years
- **docker** - 4 years
- **nodejs** - 4 years
- **vuejs** - 4 years
- **c++**
- **windows**
- **xml**
- **integration** - 26 years
- **api** - 23 years
- **drupal** - 18 years
- **architecture** - 17 years
- **amazon web services** - 16 years
- **javascript** - 16 years
- **php** - 16 years
- **software** - 16 years
- **mysql** - 15 years
- **linux** - 14 years
- **salesforce.com** - 14 years
- **vue** - 14 years
- **security** - 10 years
- **bsc** - 9 years
- **msc** - 9 years
- **software deployment** - 9 years
- **troubleshooting** - 9 years
- **apache solr** - 7 years
- **leadership** - 15 years
- **programming** - 15 years
- **web development** - 24 years
- **java** - 15 years
- **jquery** - 15 years

- **lamp** - 15 years
- **open source** - 15 years
- **sql** - 15 years
- **cross-browser** - 12 years
- **media** - 11 years
- **qa** - 11 years
- **ui** - 11 years
- **bootstrap** - 10 years
- **distribution** - 10 years
- **caching** - 9 years
- **web services** - 9 years
- **.net** - 7 years
- **continuous integration** - 6 years
- **c#** - 5 years
- **laravel** - 5 years
- **less** - 4 years
- **network** - 8 years
- **memcached** - 7 years
- **angularjs** - 2 years
- **advertising** - 7 years
- **apex** - 7 years

Work Preferences

- Desired Work Settings: Remote
- Likely to Switch: True
- Willing to Relocate: False
- Travel Preference: 25%
- Work Authorization:
 - US
- Work Documents:
 - US Citizen
- **Security** Clearance: False
- Desired Hourly Rate: 90+ (USD)
- Desired Salary: 130,000+ (USD)
- Third Party: False
- Employment Type:
 - Full-time
 - Contract - Corp-to-Corp
 - Contract - Independent
 - Contract - W2
 - Contract to Hire - Corp-to-Corp

- Contract to Hire - Independent
- Contract to Hire - W2

Profile Sources

- linkedin: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/steve-walker-7b440148>
- github: <https://github.com/activeobjects>
- Dice:
<https://www.dice.com/employer/talent/profile/9b73313b569de8d4fd3d82a040b32d7d>